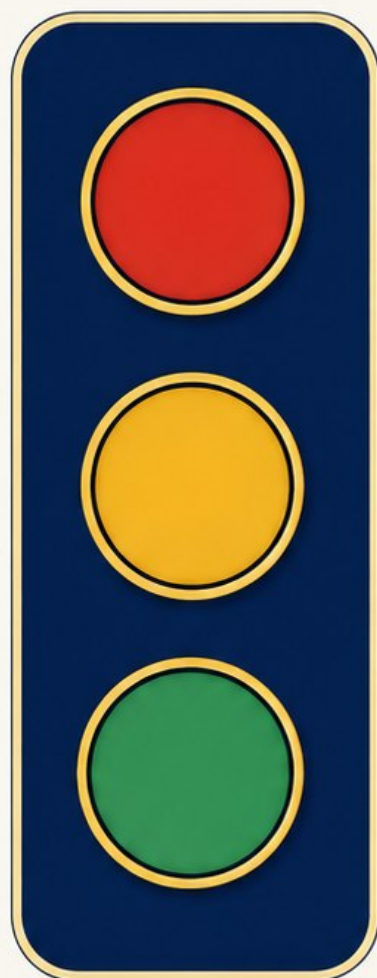


The Traffic Lights

A simple way to show students exactly how AI may be used on an assignment.

**1****RED — AI-FREE**

This is you, unassisted.
No AI at any stage.

**2****YELLOW — AI-ASSISTED**

AI can help; you drive.
Use it only as the assignment
states — and disclose it.

**3****GREEN — AI-ENCOURAGED**

Using the tool well IS the skill.
Direct it, evaluate it,
document it.

**Every assignment shows its color.**

When in doubt — ask first.
Asking is always safe.



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The Six Things Every Student Must Understand

Six truths that belong in every AI-aware classroom.

1

AI predicts from patterns.

It does not understand like a human.



2

AI can sound persuasive and still be false.

It does not know when it is wrong — that is your job.



3

Bias can live in the data and the design.

Outputs inherit their inputs.



4

What goes into AI may not come back out.

Treat every prompt like a postcard.



5

The human is responsible.

Always.



6

AI is not a person — and it is not the person to tell.

When it really matters, tell a human who can help.



UNDERSTAND THE TOOL, QUESTION THE OUTPUT, OWN THE DECISION.

The goal is not fear. The goal is informed, responsible use.



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Cite • Disclose • Verify • Own

Four habits that make student AI use visible, honest, and defensible.

1

CITE

what you
quote.

quotation marks
+ source



2

DISCLOSE

what
helped.

name the tool
and the help



3

VERIFY

what AI
mentions.

check facts,
dates, and
sources



4

OWN

what you
submit.

be able to
explain every
part



BEFORE YOU SUBMIT

- ✓ Did I check it?
- ✓ Did I disclose it?
- ✓ Can I explain it?



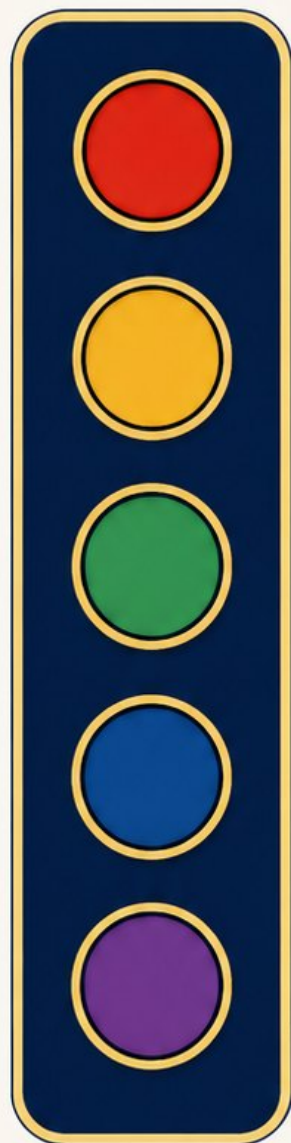
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Pause · Trace · Compare · Check · Disclose

Before you believe it, share it, or react to it:



1

PAUSE

strong feelings are the signal to slow down.



2

TRACE

where did this actually come from?



3

COMPARE

is anyone credible reporting it independently?



4

CHECK

dates, quotes, citations, hands, text, audio, backgrounds.



5

DISCLOSE

when you generate or alter something, say so.



**REACTION IS FAST.
RESPONSIBLE JUDGMENT TAKES A MOMENT.**



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The Five-Step Review

A teacher-facing checkpoint before AI-assisted material reaches students.

1**ACCURACY**

Is it factually correct?

**2****ALIGNMENT**

Does it match the objective and standard?

**3****APPROPRIATENESS**

Is it right for these students and this context?

**4****ACCESSIBILITY**

Can every learner access and use it?

**5****FINAL TEACHER JUDGMENT**

Would I put my name on this decision?

**AI DRAFTS. YOU DECIDE.**

Nothing reaches a student without your name on the decision.



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Redesign One Assignment

Use visible thinking to protect the learning goal — not just the final product.

1

NAME

what the assignment actually measures.



2

LOCATE

where that skill becomes visible.



3

CHOOSE

one or two moves: process, local & personal, performance, in the room.



4

ASSIGN

the traffic light and disclosure requirement.



5

REBALANCE

the rubric toward visible thinking.



6

EXPLAIN

to students why this assignment is designed this way.



DESIGN FOR THE THINKING YOU NEED TO SEE.



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The Career Conversation

Works for any student, any career, in about fifteen minutes.



**THE CAREER QUESTION IS NOT
'HUMAN OR AI?' — IT IS
'WHAT WILL HUMANS DO BEST?'**



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Where to Look First

There isn't one rule to consult — there's a stack.

1

Can I use AI to create lessons and materials?

LOOK FIRST: Your district's AI policy



2

Can my students use AI on this assignment?

LOOK FIRST: Your assignment instructions + district policy



3

What about student privacy and data?

LOOK FIRST: FERPA + your state's student-privacy law + your approved-tools list



4

Buying or requesting AI software?

LOOK FIRST: District procurement + your state's AI and privacy rules



5

Who owns AI-generated content?

LOOK FIRST: U.S. Copyright Office guidance + the tool's license terms



6

Is this tool accessible to all my students?

LOOK FIRST: ADA / Section 504 + your district's accessibility review



7

Is there a new law I should know about?

LOOK FIRST: Your district + your state education agency



ALWAYS ASK: WHICH LAYER APPLIES HERE?



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The 30-Day Plan

One small step per school day. Fifteen minutes or less. Cross them off.

1

WEEK 1 – UNDERSTAND

☐ 1☐ 2☐ 3☐ 4☐ 5

2

WEEK 2 – USE

☐ 6☐ 7☐ 8☐ 9☐ 10

3

WEEK 3 – EVALUATE

☐ 11☐ 12☐ 13☐ 14☐ 15

4

WEEK 4 – ESTABLISH

☐ 16☐ 17☐ 18☐ 19☐ 20

5

DAYS 21–30 – IMPLEMENT, LISTEN, REVISE

☐ 21☐ 22☐ 23☐ 24☐ 25☐ 26☐ 27☐ 28☐ 29☐ 30

Starting mid-year?

Nothing here cares what month it is.



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